

IN PRACTICE

Three surfaces, corrected

The mantel

Was: five framed photos in a row. Now: one wide print, off-centre, and a stretch of bare wall beside it. The asymmetry — *fukinsei* — does the work the symmetry couldn't.

The coffee table

Was: a tray, two books, a candle, a coaster set, a small plant. Now: the tray, one book, the branch. The other things weren't wrong. There were just too many right things.

The shelf

Was: filled, end to end. Now: two-thirds full, grouped in odd numbers, the last third left as air. The shelf finally looks chosen rather than stocked.

